CHUYI ZHANG

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EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong
Ph.D. in Finance — 2021–2027 (expected)
B.B.A. in Accounting and Finance (First Class Honours) — 2018

University of California, Berkeley
Visiting Student — 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial Disclosure; Household Finance; Asset Management; Financial Analysts

WORKING PAPERS

Reconsidering Fund Fees: Disclosure Salience and the Decision to Stay *[JMP; solo-authored] Draft available upon request.*

Abstract: Mutual fund investors choose once but pay for years. Because ownership continues by default and expenses are deducted from assets rather than billed, investors may keep paying for a fund that is no longer worth its fee. I ask whether sending existing investors more salient expense information changes whether they remain invested. The SEC's Tailored Shareholder Report reform replaced lengthy reports with short, class-specific reports that put expenses first. Using staggered first-report timing across funds' fiscal calendars, I find that retail flows become more fee-sensitive. A one-standard-deviation higher expense ratio is associated with an additional annual net-flow reduction of 3.4 percentage points. Institutional classes of the same funds, whose investors rely less on these reports, show no significant change. Redemptions of existing capital account for most of the early response. Fee sensitivity rises more where earlier reports made expenses harder to locate and following deterioration in relative performance. As investors become more fee-sensitive, high-fee funds respond by lowering fees relative to peers and moving portfolios further from their benchmarks. These findings show that delivering an already-public cost in a salient form can weaken inertia without asking investors to choose again.

— Presentations: RBFC 2026; FMA Doctoral Consortium 2026

Discounting Chinese Industrial Policy (*with Andrew Sinclair*) [Link]

Conditionally accepted, ***European Economic Review*** [SSRN]

Abstract: Each year, the Chinese central government issues dozens of policy documents directing its local officials to promote the development of targeted industries. Although central support is valuable in expectation, the duration and intensity of support are uncertain and revealed only over time. We find that small supported firms earn approximately 7.2% in annualized abnormal returns relative to a leading Chinese asset-pricing benchmark. We demonstrate that the pattern of these returns is consistent with rational discounting of policy-support uncertainty and is difficult to reconcile with alternative explanations based on systematic mispricing. Together, our results reveal an important market dynamic that is rooted in China's unique political economy.

— Media coverage: VoxChina

— Presentations: USC (China Workshop)*, University of Toronto*, HKU Business School, USC (Finance)*

Underwriting Optimism: Analyst Bias toward IPO Peers (*with Yuchou Peng*) [Link]

Abstract: Lead underwriter analysts make favorable recommendations for issuers' product-market peers to boost IPO valuations, a phenomenon we term *Peer-firm IPO Optimism* (PFIO). Buy probabilities rise by 5.5% and sell probabilities fall by 21.8% relative to their unconditional means. PFIO increases with underwriting responsibility, peer size, investor attention, and valuation complexity. However, earnings and long-term growth forecasts show no greater optimism, consistent with underwriting incentives rather than sincere optimism. Affected buys and upgrades elicit no significantly weaker announcement responses but underperform unaffected recommendations over longer horizons. Unlike direct-affiliation bias, PFIO is not detectably weaker at banks sanctioned under the Global Settlement.

— Presentations: AsianFA 2025*, AFBC 2025, HKU Business School, Erasmus University (RSM)*, RBFC 2026*, FMA 2026, TFA 2026

— Best Presentation Award, 2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop, 2026

Why (How) Do Analysts Make Multiple Forecasts in a Day? (*with Tse-Chun Lin*) [Link]

Abstract: Analysts increasingly issue earnings forecasts for multiple firms on the same day ("forecast clustering"), accounting for 55.9% of one-year-ahead EPS forecasts in 2024. Because clustering is associated with lower forecast accuracy, we examine why clustering occurs and when analysts avoid it. Clustering is more prevalent when workload creates scheduling congestion, including concurrent earnings announcements, elevated news activity at other portfolio firms, and exact-second same-industry forecast batches. Clustering is less common for career-relevant firms and for forecasts accompanied by recommendation revisions, consistent with strategic effort allocation under capacity constraints. Firms persistently exposed to clustered forecasts exhibit wider bid–ask spreads and higher illiquidity.

— Presentations: AFA 2025 (poster), AsianFA 2025, HKU Business School

** Presented by a coauthor.*

PUBLICATIONS

Retail Hedge Funds (*with Andrew Sinclair*)
Journal of Alternative Investments, 28(3), 8–27, 2026 [DOI]

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Frontier Knowledge in Education and Analyst Performance

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant (HKU)

PMBA6003 Corporate Finance (Evaluation: 4.92/5)	2024
MFIN7052 Green Finance and ESG	2024
MFIN7011 Credit Risk	2024
MFIN7007 Economics for Financial Analysis (Evaluation: 4.90/5)	2024
MFIN7053 Fundamentals of Banking Institutions	2023

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Best Presentation Award, 2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop	2026
AFA PhD Student Travel Grant	2025
Postgraduate Scholarship, University of Hong Kong	2021–2025
FBE Ph.D. Entrance Scholarship, HKU Business School	2021
University Postgraduate Fellowship	2021
W.S. Wong Prize in Accounting and Finance	2017
Rosita King Ho Scholarship	2016
Dean's Honours List; HKSAR Government Scholarship Fund; HKU Foundation Scholarships for Outstanding Mainland Students	2014–2018

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

Ernst & Young Limited, Staff Consultant	2018 - 2021

SKILLS

Computer Skills	R, Python, SQL, LaTeX
Language Skills	Mandarin, English, Cantonese
Qualifications	Passed CFA Level III; passed HKICPA final examination

REFERENCES

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